CTSD Business Plan

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Custom Technology & Software Development (CTSD) builds custom websites, apps, client portals and system integrations for small businesses, churches, schools and nonprofits in Central Virginia and beyond.

Executive summary

CTSD can launch on about $7,000, pay its founder from Year 1, and reach about $327,000 in yearly revenue by Year 3 in the base case.

- **What it does:** builds custom websites, apps, client portals and system integrations, each with a simple editing backend, then looks after them on a monthly care plan.
- **Who it serves:** small businesses, churches, private schools and nonprofits, starting in Central Virginia, a market of 880,000 Virginia small businesses and over 2,000 Charlottesville-area nonprofits.
- **Why it wins:** it sits between cheap templates that don't fit and agencies that charge $165–$275 an hour. It offers custom work and ongoing care at small-organization prices, and it partners with platforms such as Subsplash instead of fighting them.
- **Why now:** AI-assisted development lets one skilled founder deliver agency-quality work at much lower cost, and organizations need modern tools for digital giving, sign-ups and communication.
- **Proof so far:** a live company website and a full 49-page redesign of a real church's site, scoring 96–100 on Google's speed and accessibility tests.
- **Revenue model:** project fees ($3,500–$50,000) plus care plans ($99–$499 a month). Care plans grow to about $7,000 a month by Year 3, enough to cover fixed costs and founder pay on their own.
- **Capital:** no raise is needed to start. A $25,000 bridge or a $50,000 growth loan would remove first-year risk or speed up growth; an SBA microloan through Charlottesville's Community Investment Collaborative is the likely route.

Update, October 2026: CTSD now runs two product lines. Alongside custom builds, the **Virtual Assistant** (an AI phone assistant for restaurants, at $149–$649 a month plus a $499 setup) went live on ctsdstudio.com. It adds recurring revenue from the first client. Website Launch and Organization Platform projects are at **50% off as a launch offer**.

Company overview

CTSD is a pre-revenue, founder-led technology studio with two finished demonstration projects and no outside debt.

Item	Detail
Name	Custom Technology & Software Development (CTSD)
Tagline	Technology built around your organization
Founder	Stephen Amanor Sackey (also runs Amanorsac Studio, a creative studio)
Location	Charlottesville, Virginia; serves clients remotely across the US
Legal status	Not yet registered; Virginia LLC planned before the first contract
Stage	Launched: ctsdstudio.com live, Virtual Assistant product live, first two client sites in draft (Kezia Woods, Mira's Sartorial)
Customers	Small and mid-size businesses, churches, private schools, nonprofits
Offer	Custom websites, mobile apps, client portals, custom CRMs and integrations, all with a simple editing backend; plus the Virtual Assistant, an AI phone assistant for restaurants

Mission: give organizations technology that fits how they actually work, that their own staff can update, without hiring an IT department.

Proof of work so far:

- **CTSD website:** a live company site with a design showroom, a project intake form, a free mockup request and a working admin demo.
- **Faith Christian Center International (FCCI) redesign:** a full 49-page preview of a real church's website, rebuilt with the church's own content. It scores 96–100 on Google Lighthouse performance and 98–100 on accessibility, and it works alongside the church's existing Subsplash giving and media tools.

Problem and solution

Small organizations are stuck between cheap templates that don't fit them and agencies they can't afford.

The problem

- **Templates don't fit.** DIY builders and sector platforms give every customer the same layout. The organization bends its work around the tool, and its site looks like everyone else's.
- **Staff can't keep it up.** Volunteers and office staff run most church, school and nonprofit sites. When updating is hard, sites go stale.
- **Systems don't talk.** Giving, sign-ups, email lists, calendars and records live in separate tools, so staff retype the same information.
- **Platform fees add up.** All-in-one church platforms charge a monthly fee that grows with the church, plus a fee on every gift (Subsplash: 2.3% + 30¢ per card gift).
- **Agencies are out of reach.** Full-service agencies price for larger companies, and freelancers often disappear after launch.

CTSD's answer

1. **Built around the organization:** custom design and custom workflows, such as volunteer sign-ups, client portals or enrollment, not a template.
2. **Easy to edit:** every build ships with a simple backend so staff update content themselves.
3. **Connected:** CTSD links the tools a client already uses (giving platforms, CRMs, email, payments) instead of replacing what works.
4. **Looked after:** monthly care plans keep sites secure, fast and up to date, so there is always someone to call.
5. **Priced for small organizations:** a lean, AI-assisted build process keeps project costs well below a traditional agency.

Services and pricing

CTSD earns money two ways: a one-time project fee, and a monthly care plan that turns each client into recurring revenue.

Every project is quoted individually; the public website shows no prices. The ranges below are CTSD's planning prices for this business plan.

Projects (one-time)

Package	What the client gets	Planning price	Typical time
Website Launch	Custom 5–12 page site, editing backend, forms, basic SEO	$3,500–$7,500	3–5 weeks
Organization Platform	Website plus member or client area, sign-ups, giving or payments links, integrations	$8,000–$20,000	6–10 weeks
Custom App or Portal	Mobile app, client portal or custom CRM	$15,000–$50,000	2–4 months
Integration Sprint	Connect two or more existing tools (CRM, email, payments, calendars)	$1,500–$6,000	1–3 weeks

Care plans (monthly)

Plan	Includes	Price per month
Essential	Hosting, security updates, backups, uptime checks	$99
Growth	Essential plus 3 hours of edits and a monthly report	$249
Partner	Growth plus 8 hours of work, priority support, quarterly review	$499

- **Nonprofit and church rate:** 10% off project fees for registered nonprofits and churches.
- **Payment terms:** 40% deposit, 30% at design approval, 30% at launch.
- **Free mockup:** a no-cost homepage concept for qualified leads, which is CTSD's main sales tool.

Launch offer (for now): Website Launch and Organization Platform are 50% off. That puts Website Launch from $1,750 and Organization Platform from $4,000. Custom App or Portal, Integration Sprint and the care plans are at full price. The offer has no end date yet; set one before it goes on printed material.

Virtual Assistant (AI phone assistant for restaurants)

The assistant answers a restaurant's phone 24/7. It books tables, takes pickup orders, answers menu questions and hands off to staff. Every plan has a one-time **$499 setup fee**, is month to month, and starts on the day the assistant goes live.

Plan	Price	Included
Monthly (most restaurants)	$497/month	1,000 minutes, then $0.35/min
Pay as you go	$149/month + $0.40/min	No limit
Pay as you go with a cap	$149/month + $0.45/min	Never more than $649 a month

Cost to CTSD is about $0.14 a minute plus $2 a month per phone number, and card fees of 2.9% + 30¢. A typical Monthly client nets about $340 a month.

Market analysis

CTSD sells into a $43.5 billion US web design industry (IBISWorld, 2024). Its plan needs only about 50 clients in three years, a tiny share of a very large pool of organizations.

Segments (United States)

Segment	Number of organizations	Signal of need
Small businesses	36.2 million (SBA Advocacy, 2025)	17% still have no website (Clutch, 2025)
Nonprofits	About 1.54 million 501(c)(3)s (Statista, 2024)	Rely on small staff and volunteers to run their sites
Churches and congregations	About 350,000 (Hartford Institute)	94% now use digital giving; 63% expect apps to matter more within 3 years (Pushpay, vendor study)
Private K-12 schools	29,700 (NCES, 2021–22)	Need enrollment, parent communication and event tools

Home market: Central Virginia

- **Virginia** has 880,366 small businesses; 157,804 of them have employees (SBA Advocacy Virginia profile).
- **Charlottesville** has 863 registered nonprofits, and the metro area has 2,152 with over $3 billion in combined revenue (Cause IQ).

What the target market looks like

- **Total market:** US web design and development services, $43.5 billion a year.
- **Reachable market:** small businesses with employees, nonprofits, churches and private schools in Virginia and in the founder's church networks nationwide.
- **3-year goal:** about 50 projects and 30 care-plan clients, about $327,000 in Year 3 revenue in the base case.

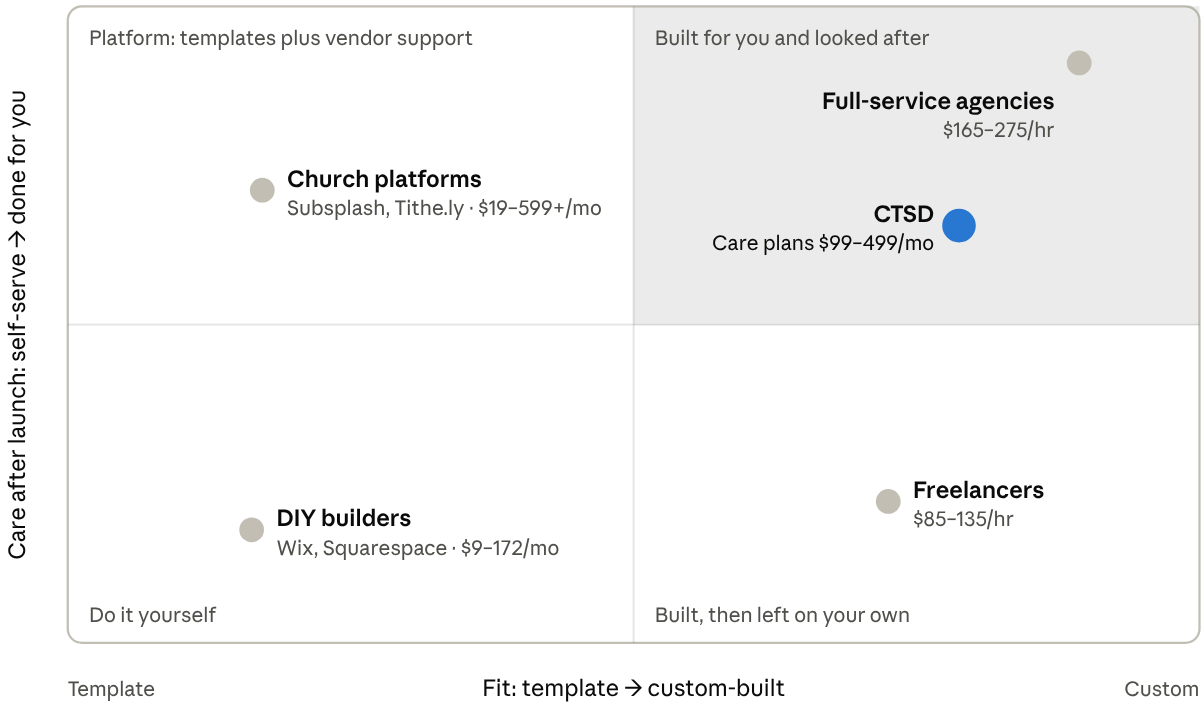
Trends in CTSD's favor

- **Custom software demand is growing fast:** the US custom software market was $9.08 billion in 2023, growing 18.5% a year (Grand View Research).
- **Digital giving keeps growing:** US giving reached $617 billion in 2025, up 5.7% (ECFA on Giving USA). Churches and nonprofits need modern tools to receive it.
- **AI lowers build costs:** this pressures one-time project prices, so CTSD builds recurring care-plan revenue from day one.

Competition and positioning

CTSD competes on fit and care, not on the lowest monthly price: it is the only option that is both custom-built and looked after at small-organization prices.

CTSD offers custom work with ongoing care, a corner held only by costly agencies



Positioning map · placements are CTSD's judgment by zone; prices from the sources listed

- **DIY builders** are cheapest but leave all the work to the organization (price comparison).
- **Church platforms** bundle giving, apps and media well, but sites are template-based. Aggregators list Subsplash from about $99 a month (Capterra); Ministry Brands runs $99–$599 a month (Subger); Tithe.ly Sites start at $19 a month (Tithe.ly).
- **Freelancers** charge less than agencies but rarely offer ongoing care (rate survey).
- **Agencies** do custom work with support, at $165–$275 an hour (cost comparison). Firms marketing in Charlottesville include CyberOptik, EZ Marketing and Studio Cadette.

Positioning: CTSD partners with platforms rather than fighting them. A church keeps Subsplash for giving and its app; CTSD replaces the template website and builds the custom tools the platform can't, such as volunteer portals, school enrollment and connected systems.

The word CTSD owns: *built around you.* Every message, page and proposal comes back to fit.

Go-to-market

The first 10 clients come from the founder's own networks and a free-mockup offer, then from referrals and local search.

Channels, in order of priority

1. **Warm network:** churches and ministries the founder already knows, starting with FCCI as the first case study.
2. **Free mockup offer:** a no-cost homepage concept for qualified leads, made quickly with CTSD's build process. It shows value before asking for money.
3. **Local presence:** Charlottesville Regional Chamber of Commerce, business networking groups, and referrals through the Central Virginia Small Business Development Center.
4. **Search and maps:** a Google Business Profile and pages on the CTSD site for each of the four segments.
5. **Referral program:** 10% of the first project fee paid to anyone who sends a client who signs.
6. **Social proof:** before-and-after case studies on Instagram and LinkedIn, starting with FCCI.

Sales process

1. Lead arrives through the intake form, a referral or an event.
2. 30-minute discovery call.
3. Free mockup delivered within 5 business days.
4. Written proposal with a fixed price and scope.
5. Signed contract and 40% deposit, then the build starts.
6. Launch, then a care plan offered at handover.

Year 1 planning targets: 60 qualified leads, 25 mockups, 8–10 signed projects (a 1-in-3 mockup close rate), and at least 60% of clients on a care plan.

Operations and technology

CTSD runs as a lean, remote-first studio: one founder, modern cloud tools and AI-assisted development keep fixed costs under $1,000 a month.

How a project runs

1. **Discover:** goals, users, content and the tools the client already uses.

2. **Design:** mockups and a clickable prototype for approval.
3. **Build:** code, the editing backend, integrations and automated tests.
4. **Launch:** speed, accessibility and security checks, then go live.
5. **Care:** monitoring, updates and monthly edits under a care plan.

Technology stack

Need	Tools
Websites	Astro and static HTML on Cloudflare's global network
Apps and portals	React Native / Expo, Supabase (database, logins, storage)
Email and forms	Resend, Cloudflare Workers
Development	Claude Code (AI-assisted coding), GitHub, automated testing
Design and images	Figma, Higgsfield / Nano Banana image generation

Why this keeps costs low

- **Hosting is cheap:** static sites on Cloudflare cost little or nothing to host, so care-plan revenue is mostly margin.
- **AI speeds up the build:** AI-assisted coding and automated tests let one person deliver work that used to need a small team.
- **One reusable starter:** each new client starts from CTSD's tested template, so projects don't begin from scratch.

Quality standards: every launch targets 90+ on Google Lighthouse performance and passes accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA) checks, as the FCCI preview does today.

Founder and team

CTSD starts as a one-person studio led by a founder who combines software development, design and church and community leadership.

Stephen Amanor Sackey, Founder

- **Software and web development:** builds websites, apps and backends; built the CTSD site and the FCCI redesign end to end.
- **Design and creative direction:** founder of Amanorsac Studio, a creative studio covering branding, design and visual content.
- **Business, sales and church leadership:** experience in sales and in ministry and community leadership, which gives direct access to CTSD's church and nonprofit market.

Hiring plan

When	Role	Type	Trigger
Year 1	Bookkeeper / accountant	Contract, a few hours a month	First signed client
Year 1	Freelance developer	Contract, per project	More than 3 projects at once
Year 2	Project coordinator / sales	Part-time	40+ care-plan clients
Year 3	Full-stack developer	Full-time	$300,000+ yearly revenue

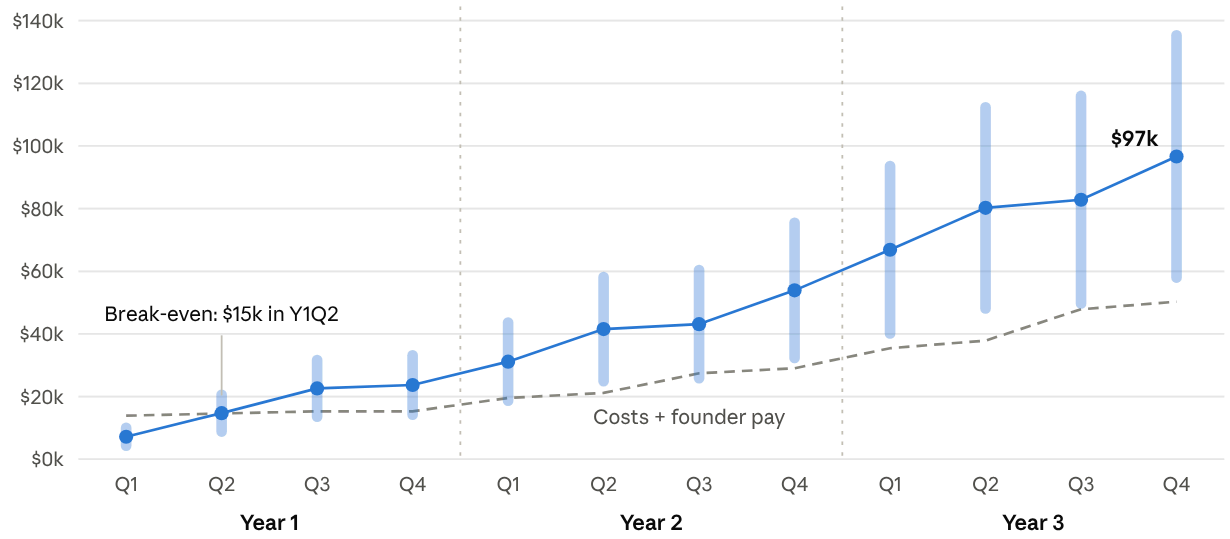
Advisors to recruit: a small-business mentor through SCORE or the Central Virginia SBDC, an attorney for contract templates, and a church or nonprofit leader as an industry advisor.

Financial plan

CTSD needs about $7,000 to start, reaches about $68,000 in Year 1 revenue in the base case, and pays the founder from its own earnings within the first six months.

Base case covers all costs and founder pay from Year 1, quarter 2

Quarterly revenue, USD. Dot = base case; whisker = pessimistic to optimistic.



CTSD planning model, October 2026 · 12 quarters, 3 scenarios · assumptions listed below

Startup costs (estimates)

Item	Cost
Virginia LLC filing and business license	$200
Attorney review of client contract	$750
Insurance, first year (liability, professional, cyber)	$1,200
Laptop and equipment	$2,500
Software and tools, first 3 months	$750
Launch marketing (print, events, ads)	$1,000
Contingency	$600
Total	**$7,000**

3-year summary by scenario (profit is before founder pay)

Scenario	Year 1 revenue	Year 2 revenue	Year 3 revenue	Year 3 profit	Care-plan clients by Year 3
Pessimistic (60% of base projects)	$40,900	$101,800	$196,000	$89,700	18
Base	$68,200	$169,700	$326,600	$197,200	29
Optimistic (140% of base projects)	$95,500	$237,600	$457,300	$304,600	41

Key assumptions

- **Projects:** 9, 16 and 24 projects in Years 1–3 (base), at average fees of $7,000, $9,000 and $11,000 as larger platform and app work grows.
- **Care plans:** 60% of clients take a plan, averaging $200, $220 and $240 a month.
- **Costs:** fixed costs of $900, $1,400 and $2,200 a month; freelance help at 10–22% of project revenue; a part-time coordinator from Year 2, Q3 ($25,000 a year) and a developer from Year 3, Q3 ($40,000 for half a year).
- **Founder pay:** $3,500 a month, paid from profit.

Break-even: the base case covers all costs and founder pay from Year 1, Q2. The pessimistic case gets there in Year 2, Q2, so the founder would need about $25,000 of savings, part-time income or a small loan to bridge the gap.

Recurring revenue: by the end of Year 3 the base case has about $7,000 a month in care-plan income, which alone covers fixed costs and founder pay.

Virtual Assistant (planning case, added October 2026)

The Virtual Assistant adds about $22,000 in Year 1 and about $197,000 in Year 3, on top of the project business above. These are planning assumptions, to be checked against the first three paying restaurants.

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Live restaurants at year end	6	20	40
Plan revenue	$18,700	$81,100	$187,200
Setup fees ($499 each new)	$3,000	$7,000	$10,000
Total revenue	$21,700	$88,100	$197,200

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Direct costs (minutes, numbers, card fees)	$6,200	$26,700	$61,600
Gross profit	$15,600	$61,400	$135,600

Assumptions:

- Restaurants are added evenly through each year.
- Average plan revenue is $520 a month per restaurant, a Monthly-heavy mix with some overage.
- Direct cost is about $171 a month per restaurant: about 1,100 minutes at $0.14, plus $2 for the number and card fees.

By the end of Year 3, the Virtual Assistant would bring in about $20,800 a month in recurring revenue.

Effect of the 50% launch offer

If six of the nine Year 1 projects are Website Launch or Organization Platform at half price, Year 1 project revenue falls by about $16,500. That takes Year 1 base revenue from about $68,200 to about $51,700, before the Virtual Assistant. The offer trades early margin for faster first clients and case studies; end it once the first five projects are signed.

Funding

CTSD is not raising money today: it can launch on about $7,000. Outside capital would buy speed and a safety margin, in one of two sizes.

Option	Amount	What it pays for	Effect
Bridge	$25,000	Startup costs, plus founder pay through the slow start of the pessimistic case	Removes the risk of the founder needing a second job in Year 1
Growth	$50,000	The bridge, plus a freelance developer and $10,000 of marketing in Year 1	Brings the Year 2 project volume forward by about two quarters

Where the money would come from

- **Founder savings** for the $7,000 start.
- **SBA Microloan:** up to $50,000 over as long as 6 years, typically 8–13% interest; the average loan is about $13,000 (SBA; NerdWallet).
- **Community Investment Collaborative (CIC):** an SBA microlender based in Charlottesville that made $1 million in microloans in 2023 (SBA lender list).
- **Central Virginia SBDC:** free advising and business-plan review in Charlottesville (listing).
- **Later, SBA 7(a) small loans** (up to $350,000) once CTSD has revenue history; they are hard to get before revenue (NerdWallet).

Repayment ability: a $25,000 microloan over 5 years at 10% costs about $530 a month. In the base case, Year 1 profit after founder pay is about $9,000, and Year 2's is about $72,000.

Risks and mitigations

The biggest risk is a slow first year of sales; most of the plan's design (free mockups, care plans, low fixed costs) exists to survive it.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Response
Slow first sales	High	High	Warm-network launch, free mockups, the referral program; costs kept under $1,000 a month; a bridge loan held as backup
One founder does everything	High	High	Freelance developers on call; documented, repeatable build process; hire a coordinator in Year 2
Clients pick cheap templates	Medium	Medium	Sell fit and care, not pages; partner with platforms such as Subsplash instead of replacing them
AI lowers what clients will pay for builds	Medium	Medium	Grow care-plan income, which AI does not replace; use AI to cut CTSD's own build time
Scope creep on fixed prices	Medium	Medium	Written scope, change-request terms, and milestone payments in every contract

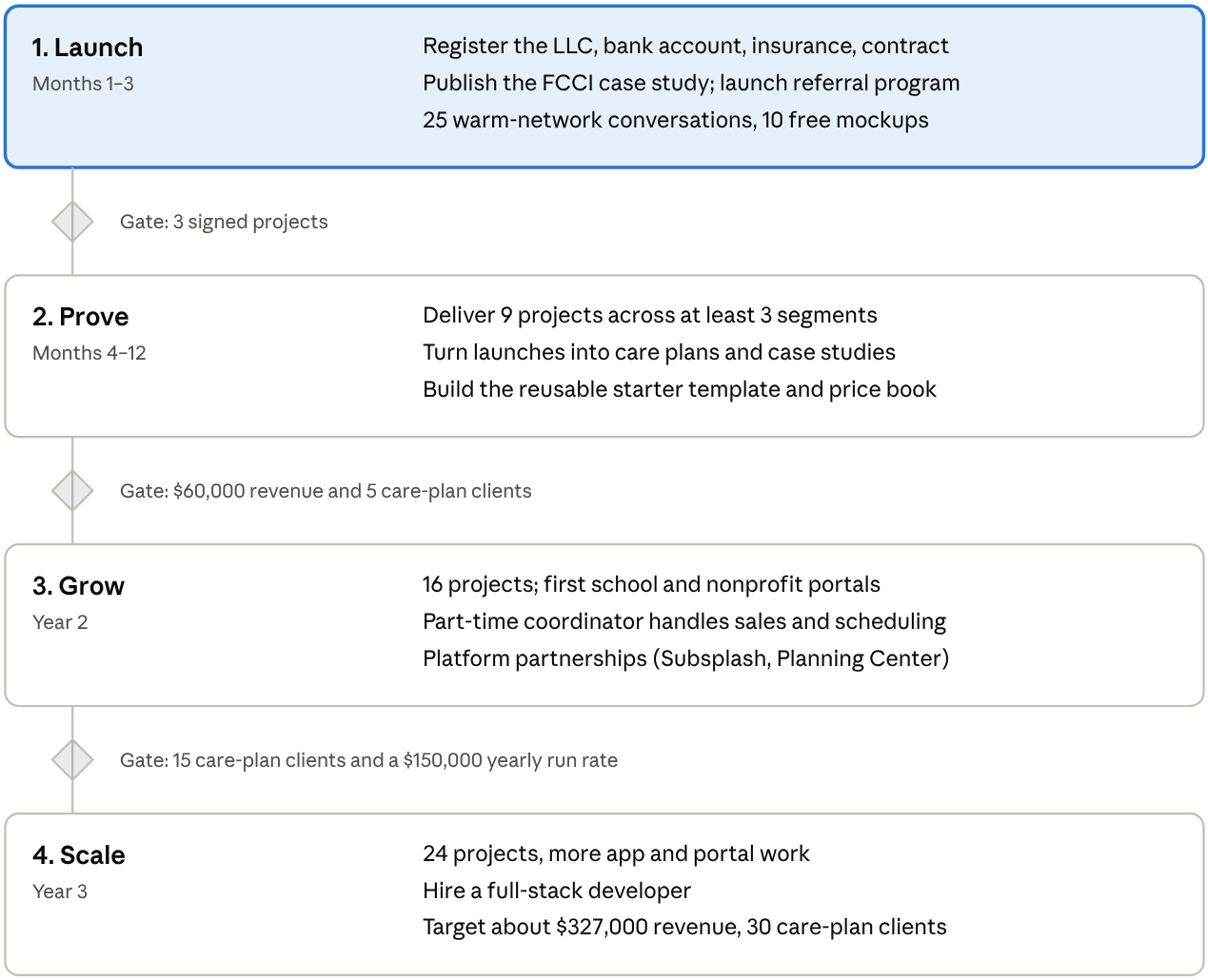
Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Response
Security issue or site outage	Low	High	Managed hosting, backups, monitoring, no stored card data, cyber insurance
Late client payments	Medium	Low	40% deposit up front; work pauses when a milestone payment is overdue

Milestones

CTSD moves to the next phase only when it passes a measurable gate, so spending grows with proven demand.

Four phases over 36 months, each unlocked by a measurable gate

Month 1 = the month the LLC is registered



CTSD roadmap · 4 phases, 3 gates, base case

If a gate is missed, CTSD stays in that phase, keeps costs flat and adjusts its sales channels before hiring.

Legal and compliance

A web studio needs no special state license, but it does need a registered company, written contracts, insurance and careful data handling.

Item	What it covers	Status
Virginia LLC	Register with the Virginia State Corporation Commission; get an EIN from the IRS	To do
Local business license	Business license from the City of Charlottesville or Albemarle County, depending on address	To do
Business bank account	Separate business finances from personal	To do
Client contract	Scope, payment schedule, ownership of code and content, change requests, care-plan terms	To do (attorney review)
Insurance	General liability plus professional liability (errors and omissions) and cyber coverage	To do
Accessibility	Builds meet WCAG 2.1 AA, which lowers clients' legal risk	In place
Privacy and data	Privacy policy on every site; minimal data collection; secure logins; no payment card data stored by CTSD	In place
Payments	Giving and payments run through processors such as Stripe or Subsplash, never through CTSD's servers	In place
Image rights	AI-generated images labeled for review; client photos used only with permission	In place

Open items before sharing

These gaps should be closed before the plan goes to a lender or investor.

- [ ] Add the founder's years of experience, past roles and any past client work to the founder section.
- [ ] Register the Virginia LLC, then update the legal status and add the EIN and registration date.
- [ ] Confirm startup costs with real quotes (insurance, attorney, equipment).

- [ ] Confirm planning prices against the first 3 real proposals.
- [ ] Add letters of support or testimonials, starting with FCCI if the church approves the redesign.
- [ ] Pull Charlottesville and Albemarle business and church counts from Census County Business Patterns.
- [ ] Re-check the market and pricing figures against the original source pages; several come from search summaries and vendor blogs.
- [ ] If seeking a loan: add a personal financial statement and a monthly cash-flow sheet (the SBDC can help with both).
- [ ] Set an end date or client limit for the 50% launch offer.
- [ ] Confirm the Virtual Assistant planning case (restaurants per year, average bill) against the first three paying restaurants.
- [ ] Check call-recording consent rules in each state before a restaurant goes live there.

Sources

Figures were gathered in October 2026. Vendor and blog prices are indicative.

- IBISWorld: US web design services market size
- Grand View Research: US custom software development market
- Clutch via Business Wire: 17% of small businesses still offline
- SBA Office of Advocacy: small business profile
- SBA Office of Advocacy: Virginia profile
- Hartford Institute: fast facts on US congregations
- Pushpay: church giving statistics
- Statista: number of US nonprofits
- NCES: private school fast facts
- Cause IQ: Charlottesville metro nonprofits
- ECFA: US giving exceeded $600 billion in 2025
- Website Builder Expert: Wix vs Squarespace vs WordPress
- Capterra: Subsplash pricing
- Subsplash: official pricing
- Subger: Ministry Brands pricing
- Tithe.ly: pricing

- Second Talent: US freelancer rates
- Project Cost Estimator: freelancer vs agency cost
- SBA: microloans
- SBA: Virginia microlenders
- NerdWallet: SBA microloans
- NerdWallet: SBA 7(a) loans
- Venturize: Central Virginia SBDC